

SEVEN MINUTES

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Original work, bundled with Ripple

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demo-scripts/03-seven-minutes

1 INT. TRANSPLANT SUITE - NIGHT 1

A steel flask goes into a padded case. A gloved hand seals it and writes a time on the lid in marker: 23:41.

SURGEON

Seven minutes of margin. Not eight.

2 EXT. HOSPITAL LOADING BAY - NIGHT 2

MATÍAS REYES, 30s, courier, takes the case two-handed and puts it in the footwell of a white van.

The van has a magnetic decal on the door and a dent in the offside wing that has been there a while.

3 INT. WHITE VAN - CONTINUOUS 3

Matías clips the case in. Starts the engine. A dashboard light stays orange and he ignores it.

DISPATCH (V.O.)

Bridge is shut. You're going round.

MATÍAS

Round is nine minutes.

DISPATCH (V.O.)

Then round is what you've got.

4 EXT. RIVER ROAD - NIGHT 4

The white van comes out of the bay fast and turns away from the river.

Sodium light, wet tarmac, no other traffic.

5 INT. WHITE VAN - CONTINUOUS 5

Matías drives with the heel of one hand. Checks the case. Checks the clock.

The passenger door opens at thirty miles an hour.

A WOMAN swings in and pulls it shut behind her. Late 40s. Wet coat. No bag.

THE PASSENGER

Keep driving.

MATÍAS

Get out.

THE PASSENGER

At this speed?

6 INT. WHITE VAN - CONTINUOUS 6

MATÍAS
There's a hospital at the other end
of this.

THE PASSENGER
I know what's in the box.

7 EXT. UNDERPASS - NIGHT 7

The van goes under. Strip lights strobe across the
windscreen.

8 INTERCUT - VAN AND CONTROL ROOM 8

INT. AMBULANCE CONTROL ROOM - NIGHT

BÉLA VARGA, 50s, dispatcher, watches a slow green dot on a
map.

BÉLA
Reyes, you have a second heat
signature in that cab.

INT. WHITE VAN - CONTINUOUS

MATÍAS
I'm aware.

BÉLA (V.O.)
Do you want me to call it in?

Matías looks at the woman. She looks back.

MATÍAS
Not yet.

END INTERCUT

9 EXT. MARKET STREET - NIGHT 9

Barriers. A closed street. The van brakes hard and the tyres
let go on wet cobbles.

STUNT: the van slides sideways into a line of empty crates
and stops.

10 INT. WHITE VAN - CONTINUOUS 10

The case has come out of its clip. Matías gets it back in
with one hand.

THE PASSENGER
You're four minutes down.

MATÍAS

Five.

11 EXT. MARKET STREET - CONTINUOUS 11

The offside wing of the white van is crumpled back into the tyre. The old dent is gone under a new one.

The wheel rubs. It will keep rubbing.

12 OMITTED 12

13 EXT. CANAL PATH - NIGHT 13

Too narrow for the van and he takes it anyway. Bollards go past a hand's width from the mirrors.

14 INT. WHITE VAN - CONTINUOUS 14

THE PASSENGER

My daughter is on that list. Further down than whoever this is.

MATÍAS

That isn't how it works.

THE PASSENGER

I know precisely how it works. That's the problem.

15 EXT. CANAL PATH - NIGHT 15

The rubbing tyre starts to smoke. A thin grey line follows the van along the water.

16 INT. AMBULANCE CONTROL ROOM - NIGHT 16

Béla watches the dot slow.

BÉLA

(into headset)

Reyes. You're losing speed.

17 INT. WHITE VAN - CONTINUOUS 17

MATÍAS

I've lost a tyre.

BÉLA (V.O.)

How far?

MATÍAS

Two streets. Maybe.

18 EXT. CANAL PATH - NIGHT 18
The tyre goes. The van drops onto the rim and grinds to a stop with sparks coming off the offside.

19 INT. WHITE VAN - CONTINUOUS 19
Silence. The engine ticks.
Matías unclips the case.

THE PASSENGER
Give it to me.

MATÍAS
No.

THE PASSENGER
I'm faster than you.

He looks at her. She is not lying.

20 EXT. CANAL PATH - NIGHT 20
Matías gets out with the case. Starts to run.
The woman gets out the other side and runs with him.

21 EXT. CANAL STEPS - NIGHT 21
Sixty steps up. He takes them two at a time and loses ground anyway.
She reaches the top first and holds a hand down.

22 EXT. HOSPITAL APPROACH - NIGHT 22
They come out onto a road with the hospital lit at the end of it.
Neither of them is running any more. Both of them are still moving.

23 INT. AMBULANCE CONTROL ROOM - NIGHT 23
Béla stands up to see a screen she does not need to stand up to see.

BÉLA
He's on foot.

24 EXT. HOSPITAL APPROACH - NIGHT 24
THE PASSENGER
Ninety seconds.

MATÍAS

Then take it.

He holds the case out. She does not take it.

25 EXT. HOSPITAL APPROACH - CONTINUOUS 25

THE PASSENGER

If I carry it I'll want to drop it.

She takes his elbow instead and pulls him forward.

26 INT. HOSPITAL ENTRANCE - NIGHT 26

Automatic doors. A trolley team waiting. A nurse takes the case and it is gone.

The clock over the desk reads 23:47.

27 INT. HOSPITAL CORRIDOR - NIGHT 27

Matías puts his back against the wall and slides down it.

The woman stands where she stopped. She does not sit.

28 INT. HOSPITAL CORRIDOR - CONTINUOUS 28

MATÍAS

What's your name?

THE PASSENGER

Ilona Nagy.

MATÍAS

Your daughter's on the list.

ILONA

Two hundred and eleven.

29 EXT. CANAL PATH - DAWN 29

The white van on its rim, offside wing crumpled, one tyre gone to canvas.

A recovery truck backs up to it in the grey light.

30 INT. AMBULANCE CONTROL ROOM - DAY 30

Béla writes 23:47 in a log and underlines it once.

She writes a second line below it and does not underline that one.

FADE OUT.